

The Sports Beat



Phils Pitching Needs Help; Parachutists Plan Meet At Airport Saturday

By BOB McCURLEY
(Intelligencer Sports Editor)

The Phillies certainly haven't done anything in the way of showing their new manager they can play baseball. Milwaukee humbled them in two games over the weekend as Gene Mauch took over the reins.

The only time they have looked like a baseball team so far was when Andy Cohen served as interim manager and they downed the Braves 5-4 in overtime last Thursday night.

Through the first four games of the season it seems the one department the Phillies were supposed to have any strength in — pitching — is the one department they don't have any strength in.

Robin Roberts has been thumped hard in two appearances, Curt Simmons lasted only a couple of innings and Johnny Buzhart gave up six runs in his only starting assignment. Ruben Gomez looked good in a couple of relief roles but he had his comeupance Saturday when the Braves teed off for five runs off him. Don Cordwell is the only one who has looked like a pitcher.

Of course, Jim Owens and Gene Conley haven't been tried yet. The former was in Eddie Sawyer's dog house due to a Florida bar room brawl and Conley was busy helping the Boston Celtics win the National Basketball Association title. Big Gene is in Florida now getting into shape and should join the club in a week or so.

Mauch better hope that these two come through. If they don't he, and the Phillies, are really going to be in a bad way. As things now stand the ball club looks like it has a little punch with Bobby Del Greco and Harry Anderson hitting the long ball. The competent but aging Alvin Dark at third, Eddie Bouchee, who is always dependable, and rookies Dick Coker and Tony Curry.

It was Connie Mack who first observed that pitching was 75 percent of a winning ball club. So far the Phillies pitching has been 25 percent of the club.